

Recipes for sunny sites

SUMMER FOCAL POINT FOR A PATIO

A dramatic flowering maple creates the central feature in this summer display, lending height and stature to the mix—you may need to support its stems with a discreet stake or two—while purple verbenas, white petunias, and the trailing silver licorice plant form a skirt around the edge. Plant this combination in all-purpose potting soil, incorporating a few slow-release fertilizer granules as you go along, and keep it well watered throughout summer. If the flowers start to flag toward the end of the season, apply a liquid fertilizer to perk them up.

Plant list

- 1 *Petunia* 'Trailing White'
- 2 *Verbena*—purple form
- 3 *Abutilon* 'Nabob'
- 4 *Helichrysum petiolare*



HERB FUSION

Herbs mix easily into a sunny mixed border on free-draining soil. Golden oregano makes a colorful edge, and bronze and green fennel make decorative feathery towers in midsummer, shading plants like Siberian bugloss that prefer cooler conditions (remember to snip off the fennel seeds frequently before they self-seed). Also try a bright yellow-flowered Scotch broom at the back of the bed to inject a splash of color in spring.

Plant list

- 1 *Origanum vulgare* 'Aureum'
- 2 *Brunnera macrophylla*
- 3 *Foeniculum vulgare* 'Purpureum'
- 4 *Foeniculum vulgare*
- 5 *Potentilla recta* 'Warrenii'

